



🇳🇱 Day 15 · Wednesday, Sep 2 · AMSTERDAM — Museums Day

Prepared for Divyansh · Pure-Vegetarian Edition · Europe 2026



Solo · Pure Vegetarian · Base: central Amsterdam hostel · Friend: Sarthak in town

The day in one line: Van Gogh at 09:00 (✅ booked) → small-boat canal cruise → Foodhallen lunch → Rijksmuseum (~14:30) → Vondelpark + "I amsterdam" letters → Anne Frank House (if a slot opens) → veg dinner in De Pijp.

🕒 WHEN TO WAKE / LEAVE

Time	Action
~07:45	Wake. Veg breakfast at the hostel or a nearby café.
~08:20	Leave hostel → tram 2 or 12 to Museumplein (or a pleasant ~20–25 min walk through the canals). Tap OVpay contactless on board.
~08:45	Arrive Museumplein (the museum square). Van Gogh Museum is at Museumplein 6 .
~08:50	Be at the Van Gogh entrance with your QR ticket open on your phone.

Time	Action
09:00	 Van Gogh entry — your booked slot (enter within the 9:00–9:30 grace window).

HOUR-BY-HOUR TIMELINE

Time	Activity	Notes / Why
09:00–11:00	 Van Gogh Museum  (Museumplein 6)	World's largest Van Gogh collection — <i>Sunflowers</i> , <i>Almond Blossom</i> , <i>The Bedroom</i> , the self-portraits — arranged chronologically. Enter within the 9:00–9:30 window. ~2h.
11:00–11:20	Walk to the canal cruise dock	Most central-canal cruises leave near the main canals / Centraal. Confirm your exact dock when you book the cruise.
11:30–13:00	★ Canal cruise — small open boat (~90 min)	Fun young guides, BYO drinks, far better than the big glass tour boats. See the Golden-Age canal houses and houseboats from the water.
13:15–14:15	 Lunch — Foodhallen (Bellamyplein 51)	Indoor food hall, many veg stalls. Quick, reliable, buzzy refuel.
14:30–16:30	★ Rijksmuseum (Museumstraat 1)	The Dutch national museum — Rembrandt's The Night Watch , Vermeer's The Milkmaid , Golden-Age masterpieces, and the stunning library & building itself. Right next to Van Gogh (2-min walk). ~2h.
16:45–17:45	Vondelpark + "I amsterdam" letters	The city's big green lung, 5 min from the museums. Relax, people-watch, grab the classic Museumplein photo.
~18:00	★ Anne Frank House (Prinsengracht 263) — <i>only if you land a slot</i>	The actual hidden annex where Anne Frank hid and wrote her diary. Profoundly moving. Still sold out — see booking note. If any slot opens (any day/time), grab it and rearrange around it.
19:45–21:00	 Dinner in De Pijp	Lively foodie district south of the centre, stacked with veg options. Meet Sarthak if he's free.

Flexibility: If Anne Frank gives you an **evening** slot, do it at ~18:00 and push dinner later. If it's a **different day/time**, keep it and move only that block. The core of today is Van Gogh → cruise → lunch → Rijks → Vondelpark → dinner.

TICKETS

-  **Van Gogh Museum** —  **booked, 09:00 (QR ready)**. Arrive ~08:50, join the timed-entry queue, scan the QR at the door, enter within 9:00–9:30. Large bags go to the cloakroom.
-  **Rijksmuseum** — **to book (do this ASAP)**. Book a **timed slot around 14:30** at the official Rijksmuseum site. It sells out on busy days — book a day or two ahead, not at the door. QR →

scan at entrance.

- 🟡 **Anne Frank House — to book (still sold out — keep refreshing).** Book **only on the official Anne Frank site** — any reseller is a scam. Tickets are timed-entry and release in batches. **Refresh several times a day, check every Amsterdam day and every slot** — cancellation drops appear unpredictably. If you get any slot, take it immediately. They're strict on time; no large bags; no photos inside the annex.
 - ⭐ **Canal cruise — to book.** Book the small-boat guided cruise directly; small groups fill up. **Confirm the departure dock** so you know where to be at ~11:30.
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TRANSPORT

- **Museumplein cluster:** Van Gogh (Museumplein 6) and Rijksmuseum (Museumstraat 1) are next to each other — 2-min walk. Vondelpark is 5 min further.
 - **From hostel: Tram 2 or 12** toward Museumplein/Vondelpark. **Tap OVpay contactless on AND off** (tap out or you're overcharged). No paper ticket needed. Or walk ~20–25 min through the canals.
 - **Canal cruise + Anne Frank** sit in the canal belt / Jordaan — walkable or a short tram hop.
 - **De Pijp** (dinner) is just south of Museumplein — walkable from Vondelpark, or a quick tram.
 - ⚠️ **Watch the red-paved bike lanes** — cyclists have priority and move fast.
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VEGETARIAN FOOD

- **Lunch — Foodhallen:** veg **bao, gyoza/dim sum, falafel & halloumi plates, wood-fired veg pizza, fresh juices.**
- **Dutch cheese note:** ⚠️ Many traditional Dutch cheeses (Gouda etc.) use **animal rennet** — not strictly vegetarian. Ask for a **vegetarian/vegetable-rennet** cheese if you want to be sure.
- **Stroopwafel:** ✅ vegetarian (caramel-syrup waffle) — safe and delicious for a snack.
- **Dinner — De Pijp: Vegan Junk Food Bar** (loaded fries, "chicken"-style burgers, all vegan), plus Middle-Eastern, Indian and Thai spots; the Albert Cuyp street-food area is nearby.
- **Also great any meal: De Bolhoed** (canal-side veg — burritos, curries, cakes), **The Vegan Indian** (dal makhani, chana masala, paneer-style tikka, biryani, naan), **Meatless District** (jackfruit dishes, plant burgers, bowls).
- **Tip:** Install **HappyCow** — Amsterdam is Europe's best veg city; you rarely need to ask "is this veg?" here.
- Handy phrase: **"Is dit vegetarisch? Geen vlees, geen vis."** (Is this vegetarian? No meat, no fish.)

💡 PRACTICAL TIPS

- **Van Gogh grace window is 9:00–9:30** — don't miss it; be there ~08:50 with the QR open.
 - **Your two open bookings:** Rijksmuseum (book now) and Anne Frank (refresh obsessively — official site only, all days, all slots).
 - **Confirm the cruise dock** when booking so 11:30 is stress-free.
 - **Tap OVpay in AND out** on every tram.
 - **⚠️ If you pass the Red Light District:** absolutely no photos of the workers in windows — it's forbidden and enforced hard.
 - Meet **Sarthak** for the cruise or the De Pijp dinner.
 - Carry a **light rain jacket** — Dutch weather flips fast.
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🎬 Movies, Songs & Pop Culture Here (Bollywood + Hollywood)

Amsterdam is a screen-legend city — you'll walk through scenes all day:

- ❤️ **The Fault in Our Stars (2014)** — the big one. Hazel and Gus visit the **Anne Frank House** (the interior stairwell + the "It's a metaphor" moment), and share the famous kiss on the **canal-side bench on Leidsegracht** (fans still find "their" bench — take the photo). They also stroll **Vondelpark** — where you'll be at ~16:45.
 - 🇮🇳 **Queen (2014, Kangana Ranaut)** — *the* Bollywood Amsterdam moment. Rani's solo-traveller awakening plays out right here: her **hostel**, the **canals**, the **coffeeshop**, and a wander through the **Red Light District**. As a solo traveller yourself, this whole day is basically living Rani's Amsterdam chapter — lean into it.
 - 🕒 **Ocean's Twelve (2004)** — the heist crew works the Amsterdam canals and old-town lanes.
 - 💎 **Diamonds Are Forever** — classic-era James Bond passes through the diamond city and its canals.
 - 🏍️ **The Hitman's Bodyguard (2017)** — the wild **canal boat / scooter chase** tears through these exact waterways and bridges — picture it from your cruise.
 - 🏰 **Amsterdam (2022)** — the David O. Russell period drama that takes the city's name.
 - 🖼️ **Girl with a Pearl Earring (2003)** — Vermeer's world; the actual painting lives in the **Mauritshuis** in The Hague (you can see it on your Sep 4 day trip). Vermeer's **The Milkmaid** is here in the **Rijksmuseum** — spot it today.
 - 🎨 **The masters themselves:** the **Rijksmuseum** is where Rembrandt's colossal **Night Watch** hangs; the **Van Gogh Museum** is a whole film's worth of the man's life on the walls. Two of art history's biggest "characters," both on today's schedule.
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🎬 Film-location thread runs through the trip · full repo: github.com/divyanshh/trip